> reduced to the goal of a series of terrorist actions: that is "driving the Jews" from the "Sacred Land," either through terror (involving not a decisive battle but a gradual intensification of the conflict resulting in discouragement and despair) or through extermination in a jihad that mobilizes all Muslim countries around the world.[24]

From this perspective Israel's Jewish civilians become fair game. Describing this mindset, Taguieff introduced the term, "absolute antisemitism."[25]

Even before the founding of the PLO in 1964, this mindset was current and has not changed to the present.[26] Despite the photo-ops with toothy smiles and handshakes, a *Weltanschauung* of intransigent hatred still characterizes the Arab-Palestinian position with regard to Israel. Indeed, the position of the Palestinians and their supporters has remained frozen in time and has not evolved. They have become entrapped by religion and ideology. In contrast, the government of Israel and its citizens, in their desire for peace have often demonstrated an astonishing flexibility to the point of accepting major strategic risks.

If we may turn briefly to the present, one of the basic reasons for the collapse of the recent peace negotiations is the firm refusal of the Palestinian Authority to abandon its chauvinistic rejection of the idea of the Jewish State. As we may observe, the Grand Mufti of Jerusalem, Hajj Amin al-Husseini (1897–1974), proclaimed that this objection is deeply rooted in religion. As we look to the recent past, we may note that by downplaying this religious and ideological objection, American peace-makers like John Kerry and Martin Indyk revealed an egregious insensitivity and ignorance.

In addition to the basic existential objection of the anti-Zionist doctrine, there are a number of problematic points in the anti-Zionist belief-system which have been described in the Working Definition of Antisemitism of the European Monitoring Centre on Racism and Xenophobia, the EUMC. The authors gave examples of antisemitism as applied to the Jewish State:

- Denying the Jewish people their right to self-determination, *e.g.*, by claiming that the existence of a State of Israel is a racist endeavor.
- Applying double standards by requiring of it a behavior not expected or demanded of any other democratic nation.
- Using the symbols and images associated with classic antisemitism (*e.g.*, claims of Jews killing Jesus or blood libel) to characterize Israel or Israelis.
- Drawing comparisons of contemporary Israeli policy to that of the Nazis.

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